

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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OUR THEME:

THE GREAT COMMISSION



- The great Commission was given by Christ Jesus.
- This commission (commandment) embodies what we understand today as "Missions".
- But the great commission is more than what we commonly refer to as 'Missions'.
- **IT IS ABOUT GOD'S MISSION**
- His mission is to make known to all mankind His redemptive work of salvation through His Son Jesus Christ.
- HIS MISSION IS FOR THE WHOLE WORLD TO EXPERIENCE THIS SALVATION.
- However, MISSIONS is clearly included in The Great Commission and the following truths we need to remember.
- **GOD IS THE ORIGIN OF 'MISSIONS'.**
- God is the originator of the whole concept of "missions" of going into the entire world and making disciples of all nations.
- To make the nations know what Christ has commanded and taught and show them the necessity to obey (follow) those things.
- God INITIATED this programme of worldwide discipleship which involves:
 - ▼ Someone GOING,
 - ▼ Someone PREACHING (telling), using words.
 - ▼ Someone TAKING TIME to disciple persons to be obedient to the teachings of Christ.
- **THIS IS WORLDWIDE EVANGELISM MISSION IN A NUTSHELL.**
- **GOD STARTED IT - HE WILL FINISH IT.**
- God will finish the work that he commenced.
- He does not fail or abandon his original purpose.
- He does not accept a partial fulfilment.
- He will complete the task that he set out to do.
- **BECAUSE GOD INITIATED IT; ONLY HE CAN TERMINATE IT.**
- Circumstances or changing conditions in the world or the changing mission philosophies of the church, nor financial restraints **CAN CHANGE IT.**
- **The mandate is clear and concise and remains valid and operational unit the end of the ages.**
- And Jesus promised that he would be WITH those who disciple the nations until the end of the eon (age) and that has not yet happened.

So, Jesus commission has not changed, it remains the same in all aspects and implications of his directions and responsibilities. It is still mandatory upon the church and every believer **WORLDWIDE.**

■ **THE COMMISSION IS A COMMANDMENT.**

- **Commandments are to be OBEYED!**
- **JESUS SAID HIS DISCIPLES MUST OBEY HIS COMMANDS**
John 14:15 "If you love me, you will obey what I command. NIV
John 14:21
21 Whoever has my commands and obeys them, he is the one who loves me. He who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I too will love him and show myself to him." NIV
John 15:10 If you obey my commands, you will remain in my love, just as I have obeyed my Father's commands and remain in his love. NIV
John 8:31 To the Jews who had believed him, Jesus said, "If you hold to my teaching, you are really my disciples. NIV

■ **THE COMMANDMENT OF JESUS CHRIST IS MANDATORY UPON ALL CHRISTIANS, IN ALL PLACES AND IN ALL GENERATIONS.**

- **To believe anything less** would be to question or doubt the validity of Jesus words.
- **To believe differently** is to attempt to 'escape or endeavour to remove the responsibility that has been placed upon every believer.

■ **WHAT ABOUT THE CHRISTIANS FROM THE POORER THIRD WORLD' DEVELOPING NATIONS?**

- **ARE THEY OBLIGATED TO OBEY JESUS COMMISSION?**
- **YES, THEY ARE - THERE IS NO DIFFERENCE FOR THEM.**
- **THE MANDATE OR COMMISSION OF JESUS IS MANDATORY AND OBLIGATORY UPON ALL CHRISTIANS EVERYWHERE.**
- **THIS INCLUDES THE PEOPLES AND NATIONS THAT HAVE LESS THAN THE MORE AFLUENT NATIONS.**

■ **HOWEVER**, because of the obligation that is also on the third world nations and their well-known passion to preach the Gospel to the lost, presents an exciting and a positive factor to consider.

NOTE.

- That the greater numbers of Christian's in the world today live in Asia and the developing nations and it is very conceivable to believe and expect that the next major missionary thrust into the nations will emerge from these developing nations.

■ **WHAT ABOUT THE CHURCH IN THE WESTERN AND DEVELOPED NATIONS**

- **ARE THEY ALSO OBLIGATED TO GO INTO ALL THE WORLD TEACHING ALL PEOPLE IN ALL NATIONS?**
- **THE ANSWER IS YES**, ACCORDING TO SCRIPTURE.
- **THE COMMANDMENT OF JESUS CHRIST MUST EQUALLY APPLY TO THE CHRISTIANS OF THE WESTERN WORLD AS WELL AS THOSE FROM THE 'THIRD WORLD' NATIONS**
- **GOD HAS NOT CHANGED HIS COMMISSION**

THE CRITICAL QUESTION

- **IS IT BIBLICALLY VALID FOR THOSE IN THE DEVELOPED WORLD FOR THEM TO CEASE SENDING MISSIONARIES TO THE NATIONS?**

■ **THE ANSWER IS NO.**

■ **POVERTY DOES NOT ABROGATE OBLIGATION,**

BUT NEITHER DOES RICHES OR AFFLUENCE ABROGATE RESPONSIBILITY!

- **THEREFORE, REGARDLESS OF THE PREVAILING ECONOMIC, PHYSICAL OR POLITICAL CONDITIONS OF A NATION, THE GREAT COMMISSION OF JESUS CHRIST IS STILL MANDATORY UPON ALL CHRISTIANS.**

■ **OUR RESPONSIBILITY MUST BE TO INSTRUCT, TEACH, EDUCATE, PROMOTE THE CHURCH IN ALL NATIONS TO ACTIVELY INVOLVE IN CARRYING OUT THIS MANDATE THAT JESUS GAVE.**

■ **LET'S DO IT!**

Amen – Ps Barry